THARIFITH

Riffian Language Course

LESSON 4

Greetings & Basic Phrases

LEARN THARIFITH (AEL)

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners

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1. Introduction to Riffian Greetings

You know how in some places you can just say "hey" and keep walking? That's not really how things work in Riffian culture.

In Moroccan Riffian society, greetings actually mean something. They're not just polite noises you make before getting to the real conversation, they are the real conversation sometimes. When two Riffians run into each other, there's this whole back-and-forth that happens. How are you? How's your family? Is everyone healthy? And it's not fake or rushed. People actually wait for the answers.

What I love about this is what it says about their values. Taking five minutes to properly greet someone isn't seen as wasting time... it's seen as basic decency. In our fast-paced world where we're all guilty of the quick wave-and-go, there's something refreshing about that.

So if you're trying to learn Tharifith, start with the greetings. "Azul," "Salam," "Ahlan"...these words matter. Trust me, native speakers can tell when you're making an effort, and they really respond to it. You don't need to be perfect. Just trying goes a long way.

The cool thing is, the greetings themselves teach you about the culture. You start noticing how often religion comes up, how hospitality is baked into even the simplest exchanges, how family is always part of the conversation. It's like a little window into what Riffian people actually care about.

And honestly? Learning this stuff isn't hard. But it changes everything about how you connect with people.

2. Essential Greetings

2.1 The Universal Greeting: Azul

The word "Azul" (ⴰⵣⵓⵍ) and “Salam o Âlikom” are the most widely recognized greetings in Rif, used throughout Morocco and across the Amazigh world. These versatile greetings can be used at any time of day and in virtually any social context, making it essential for every learner to master. The two greetings carry connotations of peace and well-being. The etymology of the word “Azul” goes back to the notion of proximity to the heart “ Ased ghar ur” / “Ased ghar ul” that gave us Az-ul. When used as a greeting, "Azul" essentially conveys wishes for peace and prosperity to the person being greeted.

In practice, "Azul" is often extended to "Azul khakom" (peace be upon you ‘masc. pl.) when addressing men, or "Azul khakent" (fem. pl) when addressing women. This gender

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distinction is important in Tharifith grammar and reflects the broader pattern of grammatical gender agreement that runs throughout the language. The response to "Azul" is typically "Azul", creating a symmetric exchange of peaceful wishes. The response to “Salam o Âlikom” is “Waâlikom Salam” like in arabic.

Essential Greetings Chart

Tharifith	Tifinagh	English	Usage Context
Azul	ⴰⵣⵓⵍ	Hello / Peace	Common greeting
Azul khak	ⴰⵣⵓⵍ ⵅⴰⵔ	Peace be upon you (masc.)	To a male
Azul kham	ⴰⵣⵓⵍ ⵅⴰⵎ	Peace be upon you (fem.)	To a female
Azul a uma	ⴰⵣⵓⵍ ⴰ ⵡⵎⴰ	Hello, my brother	Friendly, informal
Azul a utchma	ⴰⵣⵓⵍ ⴰ ⵡⵜⵛⵎⴰ	Hello, my sister	Friendly, informal
Salam o Âlikom	ⵙⴰⵍⴰⵎ ⵓ ⴰⵍⵉⴽⵓⵎ	Peace be upon you	Islamic Common greeting

Table 1: Essential Riffian Greetings

3. Time-Based Greetings

Alright, so here's the thing about "Azul", it's basically your safety net. You can toss it out there pretty much any time and you'll be fine. It's like the Swiss Army knife of Tharifith greetings. But here's what's actually cool: Tharifith has these specific greetings for different times of day, and honestly? Nailing the right one? That's where the real connection happens.

And it's not just some random quirk. These greetings tell a story, you can actually feel the Arabic influence woven through, but it's still got that unmistakable Amazigh soul.

Here's why it actually matters: using the right greeting at the right time isn't just about checking some cultural box. It shows you get it. You're not just repeating phrases, you're paying attention to how life actually moves. In traditional Riffian communities, the whole day flows around prayer times, the work that needs doing, where the sun is sitting in the sky. The greetings shift with that rhythm. Morning hits different than afternoon, which hits different than evening. Each one lands in its own way.

And look, nobody's going to be rude about it if you mess up. But walk in somewhere and throw out a morning greeting when the sun's already dipping low? People notice. Not in a bad way, more like a quiet "ah, they're still figuring it out." But when you get it right? There's this little moment. A subtle nod. A shift in energy.

It's a small thing. But the small things? They're usually the ones that matter most.

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3.1 Morning Greetings

So for mornings, you've got two main options: "Thifawin" or "Sbah lkhir." The first one is purely Amazigh, and the second one, yeah, you can hear the Arabic in it, but here's the thing: nobody really stops to think about that. Both of them just roll off the tongue in everyday conversation. They've become part of the same fabric.

Morning in this context stretches from dawn until roughly noon, but don't pull out your watch or anything. The boundaries are pretty loose. People feel their way through it.

And here's where it gets warm. When you greet someone in the morning, it's rarely just the greeting standing alone. You'll almost always tack on a genuine question, "mokh/mamech tsebbhedh nhara?" which is basically asking if they woke up well , or "mokh/mamech thsâdhidh sbeh?" checking in on how their morning's going. It's not filler. It's not small talk for the sake of small talk. It's a real check-in. A way of saying: I see you, you matter, how are you doing?

There's something to that. The morning greeting kind of sets the temperature for everything that comes after. Get it right, start with warmth, and the whole day flows better. It's about establishing that connection early, letting people know you're present with them.

In the rural parts of the Rif, where people have been working the land for generations, the day starts early. Like, early early. So you might hear morning greetings exchanged while most city folks are still hitting snooze. That's just the rhythm, tied to the land, tied to the work, tied to a way of life that's been running on sunlight and seasons long before any of us showed up.

Tharifith	English	Time Period	Notes
Thifawin	Good morning	Dawn to noon	Pure amazigh origin
Sbah rkhir	Good morning	Dawn to noon	Arabic-derived
Thimensiwin	Good evening/ night	Sunset to night	Evening/night greeting
Msa rkhir	Good evening/ night	Sunset to night	Arabic-derived

Table 2: Time-Based Greetings

4. Introductions and Self-Identification

After exchanging initial greetings, the next step in most conversations involves introductions. In Riffian culture, as in many cultures, proper introductions are essential for establishing social connections and determining appropriate levels of formality for subsequent interaction. The way you introduce yourself and ask about others can set the tone for the entire relationship, making it important to master these phrases early in your language learning journey. Riffian

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introductions often involve not just names but also inquiries about family and origin, reflecting the communal nature of the society where a person's identity is closely tied to their family and regional background.

4.1 Introducing Yourself

To introduce yourself in Tharifith, you can use the phrase "Nech qanay..." followed by your name, which means "I am..." or litteraly “they call me…” This simple construction is the most common way to state your name. Alternatively, you can say "Isem-ino ..." meaning "My name is..." Both forms are acceptable, though "Nech qanay..." is slightly more conversational while "Isem-ino..." might be used in more formal contexts.

When introducing yourself, it is also common to mention where you are from using "Nech zi..." (I am from...) followed by your place of origin. This additional information is often expected in Riffian introductions, as place of origin provides important social context in a culture where regional identity remains significant.

Tharifith	English	Notes
Nech qanay [name]	I am [name]	Standard introduction
Isem-ino [name]	My name is [name]	More formal
Nech zi [place]	I am from [place]	Origin identification
Min taânidh chek?	Who are you?	Asking someone's name (masc.)
Min taânidh chem?	Who are you?	Asking someone's name (fem.)
Mokh/ Mamech dak qaren?	What is your name?	To a male
Mokh / Mamech dam qaren?	What is your name?	To a female

Table 3: Introduction Phrases

5. Common Questions and Responses

In Riffian culture, greetings often extend beyond simple hello and goodbye to include inquiries about health, family, and general well-being. These questions are not merely formalities but reflect genuine interest in the other person's life. Being able to ask and respond to these questions appropriately is essential for engaging in meaningful conversations. The typical Riffian greeting exchange can involve several rounds of questions and responses, with each party taking turns to inquire about various aspects of life. This pattern of extended questioning demonstrates the value placed on community and interpersonal relationships in Riffian society.

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5.1 Health and Well-being Inquiries

One of the most common follow-up questions after an initial greeting is "mokh thedjidh? / mamech thedjidh?" meaning "How are you?" This question opens the door for a more detailed exchange about one's well-being. The response can range from simple affirmations like "Aqay mlih, Alhamdulilah" (I'm doing well, Alhamdulilah) to more detailed descriptions of one's current situation. It is also common to ask specifically about family members' health, using phrases like "mokh thedja familia?" / "mamech thedja familia?" (How is family?). These inquiries about health and family demonstrate the interconnected nature of Riffian society, where individual well-being is closely tied to family and community welfare.

Question	Meaning	Common Response
Mokh thedjidh? / Mamech thedjidh ?	How are you?	Mlih (Fine)
Mokh thedja familia? / Mamech thedja familia?	How is family?	Aqathen mlih (They're fine)
Kolchi mlih?	Is everything okay?	Kolchi mlih, Alhamdulilah, (Everything is fine, Alhamdulilah)
Min tâwadhedh	What's up ?	You tell them what's up!
Mani thzedghedh ?	Where do you live ?	Zedghegh gi …. (place/ city/ country)
Thmerkedh ? / Thmerchedh ?	Are you married ?	Yeh nech merkegh / La nich u-merkegh-chi.
Thsawaredh tharifith ? / Thsawaredh tharifecht ?	Do you speak Riffian ?	Yeh, sawaregh tharifith! / Wah sawaregh tharifecht.
Thkhedmedh ?	Do you work?	Yeh, khedmegh La u-khedmegh-chi / La wa-khedmegh-cha
Adawigh chi n tmesrayth? Adawigh chi n tmesracht?	You want me to bring something?	Udji maymmi! (no need to / No)"

Table 4: Common Questions and Responses

6. Polite Expressions

You know how in English you've got your "please" and "thank you" and "sorry", those little phrases that oil the gears of daily life? Tharifith has the same thing, and honestly, they matter maybe even more here.

In Riffian culture, there's this real emphasis on social harmony. Like, maintaining good relationships isn't just a nice bonus, it's a core value. People genuinely care about keeping things smooth between themselves and others. So when you use the right expression at the right moment, expressing gratitude the proper way, apologizing when you've stepped wrong,

asking for something without sounding demanding, you're not just following rules. You're showing that you understand the social fabric. You're saying, I respect you, I respect our relationship, I want things to be good between us.

The good news is that once you learn these expressions, how to say thank you, how to apologize, how to ask for things gracefully, they start to feel natural pretty quickly. You're not just someone speaking the language anymore; you're someone who understands how to move through the culture.

Tharifith	English	Usage Context
Âafak /Âafam Tqadigh-chek/ Tqadigh-chem Chokran	Thank you	General gratitude
Tqadigh-chek zi radjagh n‟-ur	Thank from the buttom of my heart	To a male
Tqadigh-chem zi radjagh n‟-ur	Thank from the buttom of my heart	To a female
Mrehba (a minority reclaim the ancient word Anzuf)	You're welcome	Response to thanks (Arabic word)
Samhai / Wadhmay	Excuse me / Sorry	Apology or attention
Awid	(literally 'bring')	Making requests (masc.)
khaylah	Please	Making requests (fem.)

Table 5: Polite Expressions

7. Parting Phrases

Just as proper greetings are important in Riffian culture, appropriate ways of saying goodbye are equally significant. Parting phrases often include expressions of well-wishing and hopes for future meetings. The way someone takes leave of another person can leave a lasting impression and influence future interactions. In Riffian culture, departures, like arrivals, often involve extended exchanges, particularly among friends and family members. Understanding these parting phrases will help you conclude conversations gracefully and leave positive impressions on those you interact with.

Tharifith	English	Context
Ukha anemza	See you	Until we meet again
Beslama	Goodbye	Arabic word
Anemza thiwcha	See you tomorrow	Use it with your friends and family

Tharifith	English	Context
Lah iâwen	God be with you	Religious farewell

Table 6: Parting Phrases

8. Small talks :

Where are you going?	Mani thg‟adh ?
What are you doing now?	Min teggedh rokh ?
Do you like tea?	Itaâjibak ‟atay ?
Are you fine?	Aqachek /aqachem mlih?
What are you eating?	Min tettedh?
Where is your brother?	Mani idja umak/ umach?
Do you eat eggs?	Chek/ chem tettedh thimedjarin?
I have work to do.	Ghari chgher athegegh.
I don’t understand.	u-fhimegh-chi / Wa-fhimegh-cha
Not yet.	Âadh.
Hurry up!	Azzer.
Why are you late?	Magha thâadhredh ?
What time is it?	Mech-ha thsaât?

9. Practice Exercises

9.1 Greeting Matching

Match each Tharifith greeting in Column A with its correct English meaning in Column B. Write the letter of the correct answer in the blank provided.

Column A (Tharifith)	Column B (English)
____ 1. Azul	A. Hello, my brother
____ 2. Thifawin	B. See you
____ 3. Azul a uma	C. Good morning (Arabic-derived)
____ 4. Ukha anemza	D. Hello / Peace
____ 5. Sbah lkhir	E. Good morning (Amazigh origin)
____ 6. Azul kham	F. Peace be upon you (feminine)
____ 7. Lah iâwen	G. Goodbye
____ 8. Thimensiwin	H. Hello, my sister
____ 9. Azul a utchma	I. Good evening/night
____ 10. Beslama	J. God be with you

9.2 Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the appropriate Tharifith phrase from the word bank. Each word may be used only once.

Word Bank:

Azul • Mlih • Nech qanay • Chokran • Mrehba • Samhai • Thifawin • Beslama • Isem-ino • Alhamdulilah

1. When greeting someone in the morning, you say "__" which means "Good morning."
2. If you want to introduce yourself casually, you can say "___" followed by your name.
3. When someone says "Chokran" to you, the polite response is "____."
4. If you accidentally bump into someone, you should say "_____" to apologize.
5. The universal Tharifith greeting that can be used at any time is "_____."
6. When asked "Mokh thedjidh?" (How are you?), you might respond "Aqay mlih, ____."

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7. A more formal way to introduce yourself is "_____" followed by your name.
8. To express gratitude to someone, you say "_____."
9. When leaving a gathering, you can say "_____" as a friendly farewell.
10. A simple response to "How are you?" is "_____" which means "Fine."
    "_____" is the response meaning "You're welcome."

8.3 Gender-Specific Forms

Write the correct form for addressing a male or female:

Situation	To a Male	To a Female
Hello	Azul khak	_____
How are you?	_____	Mamech thedjidh chem?
What is your name?	Mokh dak qaren?	_____
How are you?	_____	Mamech thedja familia?

Part B: Write the correct form for each scenario described below.

1. You are greeting your brother's wife. Write the appropriate greeting:
   _____
2. You meet your male friend in the market. Greet him informally:
   _____
3. A woman asks you "Mamech thedjidh?" Respond that you are fine:
   _____
4. You need to ask a man where he lives. Write the question:
   _____
5. You want to ask a woman if she speaks Riffian:
   _____
6. Thank a man sincerely from the bottom of your heart:
   _____

8.4 Conversation Practice

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1) Translate the following mini-dialogue into Tharifith:

1. A: Hello! (to a man)
2. B: Hello! How are you?
3. A: I am fine, thank you. What is your name?
4. B: My name is Karim, I am from Al hoceima.
5. A: Nice to meet you. Goodbye!

2) *Complete the following dialogue between two people meeting for the first time. Use appropriate Tharifith phrases based on context..*

Conversation 1:

- **Ahmed:** (greets Fatima) _____
- **Fatima:** (responds to greeting) _____
- **Ahmed:** (asks how she is) _____
- **Fatima:** I am fine, Alhamdulilah. _____
- **Ahmed:** (says he is also fine) _____
- **Fatima:** (asks his name) _____

Conversation 2 :

- **Walid:** (introduces himself) _____ Walid. And you?
- **Ibrahim:** (introduces himself) _____ Ibrahim.
- **Walid:** (asks where he is from) _____
- **Ibrahim:** I am from Nador. _____ (asks if he speaks Riffian)
- **Walid:** Yes, I speak Riffian! _____
- **Ibrahim:** (says goodbye) _____

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9. Answer Key

Answer key will be communicated later; respond to the exercices and send the responses to learntharifith@gmail.com , you will receive the correction.

10. Lesson Summary

In this second lesson, you have learned the essential greetings and basic phrases necessary for initiating and concluding conversations in Tharifith. You now know how to greet people using "Azul" and its gender-specific variations, as well as time-based greetings for different parts of the day. You have mastered the vocabulary for introducing yourself, asking about others, and engaging in the polite question-and-answer exchanges that characterize Riffian social interaction. The lesson also covered important polite expressions for expressing gratitude, making requests, and offering apologies, as well as various ways to say goodbye.

Remember that in Riffian culture, greetings are not mere formalities but meaningful exchanges that establish and maintain social bonds. Taking time to greet people properly and inquire about their well-being is an important aspect of showing respect and building relationships. As you practice these phrases, pay attention to the gender distinctions in Tharifith, as using the correct form demonstrates cultural awareness and linguistic competence. In the next lesson, we will build on this foundation by learning numbers and counting in Tharifith, which will enable you to discuss quantities, prices, dates, and other numerical concepts essential for everyday communication.

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